COVER STORY

NEWSMAKER OF THE YEAR

GAUTAM ADANI

It's the festive season and the atrium of the glass-walled Adani conglomerate headquarters in Shantigram, Ahmedabad, is decked up with white cardboard boxes stacked in tapering rows to resemble a giant pyramid reaching to the skies. The installation, 'Convergence', is meant to depict a united Adani vision of the future.

The Adani Group and founder-chairman Gautam Adani's vision was in full flow in 2022 with much to celebrate. Expanding at an explosive rate, the group's market capitalisation grew nine-fold in just three years to cross Rs 17.9 lakh crore as on December 23, making it India's second most valuable firm just behind the Tata Group but ahead of Reliance Industries. Adani even overtook Reliance Industries' Mukesh Ambani to become the richest person in India and Asia, apart from becoming the world's third wealthiest with a personal net worth of over $125.8 billion (per the *Forbes* list, as on December 28).

Demonstrating his penchant for betting big, in September Adani acquired the Swiss firm Holcim's stake in ACC and Ambuja Cements for $10.5 billion (around Rs 87,000 crore), the single largest acquisition in the infrastructure space. With that, his group became the second largest cement manufacturer in the country behind industry leader UltraTech of the Aditya Birla Group. The year also saw Adani make acquisitions in diverse sectors including two popular rice brands, the

MIDAS TOUCH

2022 saw Adani's business expanding and fortune soaring. A lowdown on his growth:



WORLD'S THIRD RICHEST

With a net worth of $125.8 billion, Gautam Adani is the world's third richest person behind French fashion business tycoon Bernard Arnault ($180.5 billion) and Tesla and Twitter CEO Elon Musk ($138 billion). He also overtook Mukesh Ambani, chairman of Reliance Industries, as the richest Indian



STOCK MARKET DARLING

His group's total market capitalisation registers a phenomenal ninefold growth from Rs 1,96,917 crore on December 23, 2019 to Rs 17,90,038 crore as on December 23, 2022



BETTING BIG

Acquires Swiss firm Holcim's stake in Ambuja Cements and ACC for $10.5 billion (around Rs 87,000 crore), India's single largest deal in the infra sector, and becomes the country's second largest cement manufacturer behind Aditya Birla Group's UltraTech



EXPLOSIVE EXPANSION

Takes over controlling stake of NDTV; acquires India's largest marine services firm Ocean Sparkle and Essar's Mahan-Sipat transmission project; buys Kohinoor and Charminar rice brands from the US-based McCormick; wins, along with Gadot, tender to privatise Israel's Haifa Port; achieves financial closure for Navi Mumbai Airport for Rs 12,770 crore; enters telecom space, buying 5G spectrum worth Rs 212 crore for industrial applications; signs deal with the Odisha government to invest Rs 57,575 crore in two alumina refinery and iron ore projects



SECURING FINANCES

Gets Abu Dhabi's International Holding Company to invest $2 billion (Rs 16,568 crore) in group's green portfolio. Adani's Mumbai International Airport raises $750 million (Rs 6,213 crore) from Apollo Enterprises. Adani-Wilmar's Rs 3,600 crore IPO in January over-subscribed 17.3 times



THE BIG GIVER

On his 60th birthday in June, the Adani family commits Rs 60,000 crore to charity for healthcare, education and skill development